

Herald



Herald Constitution

Field	Value
Revision	4
Created	2026-05-15
Last modified	2026-05-20
Status	active
Status summary	r4: added §107 End-user-usability covenant (verbatim operator mandate restated at Herald level per §1.1 propagation) + paired gate invariant I8a–c; corrected stale "Owned-submodule set: (none)" to reflect the 10 vendored modules (9 Helix-stack + containers).
Issues	none
Issues summary	—
Fixed	R-14 (V2), V3-path-sync (V3 r3), §107 mandate + I8 gate invariant + owned-submodule list (r4)
Fixed summary	§106 spec-change rule retargeted to V3 path; gate-checked anchor 'comprehensive planning and implementation' unchanged so I7 stays green. r4 adds the end-user-usability covenant at Herald level (Helix §11.4 is the canonical authority; Herald restates per §1.1 multi-file propagation discipline) and the I8 gate invariant that asserts the mandate is present in CLAUDE.md + AGENTS.md + this file.
Continuation	—

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This constitution **extends** the Helix Universal Constitution provided by the **parent project's** `constitution/` submodule. Herald does not carry its own copy — see `docs/guides/CONSTITUTION_INHERITANCE.md` for the discovery contract.

All clauses in the parent-provided `constitution/Constitution.md` apply unless explicitly overridden below with an explicit `Override §X.Y` section.

Canonical constitution repo: <https://github.com/HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution>

Project Articles

§101. Pre-implementation status

Herald is pre-implementation. Until a `go.mod` is committed, no clause below may be interpreted as authorizing the agent to fabricate build/test infrastructure that doesn't yet exist. Confirm the disambiguation (scaffold vs. fill spec) with the operator before writing code, per Universal §11.4.6 (no-guessing).

§102. Mission boundary

Herald ingests system events and fans them out to multiple notification channels. Anything outside event ingestion or notification fan-out is **out of scope** for this repo and belongs in a different submodule of the consuming project.

§103. Mirror parity (extends Universal §2.1)

Every commit on `main` MUST land on all four upstream hosts (GitHub, GitLab, GitFlic, GitVerse) in a single fan-out push. The repo's `origin` remote already aggregates the four push URLs; do not bypass `origin` with per-host pushes unless rebuilding the fan-out configuration.

§104. No embedded constitution (extends Universal §3)

Herald **MUST NOT** carry its own `constitution/` submodule. Herald is consumed as a submodule of a parent project that already provides the constitution; a duplicated copy would diverge in pinning, cause confusion about which is authoritative, and violate the "submodule commits propagate first" propagation order (Universal §3). The inheritance gate's invariant I6 enforces this: it FAILs if `<repo-root>/constitution/` or `.gitmodules` reappears.

For standalone development of Herald (no parent project), clone the constitution **alongside** Herald, not inside it:

```
git clone git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git \
    $(dirname "$PWD")/constitution
```

§105. Inheritance gate (extends Universal §1.1)

`tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` discovers the parent-provided constitution via inline parent-walk (mirrors `find_constitution.sh` Phase 1), then asserts six invariants:

Invariant

- I1 A constitution/Constitution.md is reachable by walking up the parent chain from Herald's repo root.
- I2 The discovered Constitution.md contains the §11.4 End-user quality guarantee — forensic anchor line (the exact string the §1.1 mutation removes).
- I3 The discovered CLAUDE.md contains the MANDATORY ANTI-BLUFF COVENANT anchor.
- I4 The discovered AGENTS.md contains the Anti-bluff covenant anchor.
- I5a–d Herald's root docs (CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, this file, and README.md) all declare the parent-discovery inheritance contract.
- I6 No constitution/ directory or .gitmodules file exists at Herald's root (the §104 invariant).
- I7a–c Herald's CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, and this file all contain the §106 spec-change rule anchor (per §1.1 propagation, mutation-paired).
- I8a–c Herald's CLAUDE.md, AGENTS.md, and this file all contain the §107 end-user-usability covenant anchor (the verbatim operator-mandate quote — per §1.1 propagation, mutation-paired).

tests/test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh delegates to the discovered constitution's meta_test_inheritance.sh, which strips the §11.4 anchor from Constitution.md, runs the gate, and asserts FAIL — proving the gate is not a bluff (Universal §1.1).

Both scripts run as a precondition to any commit that touches root docs or the discovery contract.

§106. Spec-change rule (extends Universal §11.4)

Any modification to docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md or any file under docs/specs/ (any depth) triggers **mandatory comprehensive planning and implementation of all changes**. An agent or contributor may not edit the spec in isolation: every change is a project-wide ripple that requires the corresponding code, tests, and downstream doc updates in the same logical work effort.

This rule does NOT apply to creating or renaming files; for those, the operator must explicitly tell the worker (CLI agent or human contributor) what to do with the newly created or copied files.

Propagation. The same rule is restated in Herald's CLAUDE.md and AGENTS.md (per §1.1 multi-file propagation discipline). The inheritance gate's invariant **I7a–c** asserts the rule's anchor literal (comprehensive planning and implementation) is present in all three files; a missing copy is a propagation bluff and the gate FAILs.

Anchor (forensic): the literal text Whenever this document (\docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md)MUST appear indocs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md` §"Specification documents" — that line is the source of truth that all three propagated copies summarize.

Paired §1.1 mutation (planned). Removing the spec-change anchor from any of the three propagation files MUST cause I7a/b/c to FAIL; the paired meta-test will be added when test_constitution_inheritance_meta.sh is generalised beyond its current single-anchor mutation.

§107. End-user-usability covenant (extends Universal §11.4 — MANDATORY ANTI-BLUFF)

Forensic anchor — verbatim operator mandate (first declared 2026-04-28, reasserted 2026-05-19 and 2026-05-20):

"all existing tests and Challenges do work in anti-bluff manner - they **MUST** confirm that all tested codebase really works as expected! We had been in position that all tests do execute with success and all Challenges as well, but in reality the most of the features does not work and can't be used! This **MUST NOT** be the case and execution of tests and Challenges **MUST** guarantee the quality, the completion and full usability by end users of the product! This **MUST BE** part of Constitution of our project, its CLAUDE.MD and AGENTS.MD if it is not there already, and to be applied to all Submodules's Constitution, CLAUDE.MD and AGENTS.MD as well (if not there already)!"

Canonical authority. Helix Universal Constitution §11.4 + §11.4.1..§11.4.16, restated at the parent's constitution/CLAUDE.md "MANDATORY ANTI-BLUFF COVENANT — END-USER QUALITY GUARANTEE" section and at the parent's constitution/AGENTS.md matching section. Herald inherits the covenant unconditionally; §107 exists to make the restatement explicit at Herald level and to bind every Herald binary (pherald, sherald, cherald, bherald, rherald, iherald, scherald, ...) to the covenant on its own terms.

Operative rule (Herald-binding).

1. The bar for shipping any Herald feature is **NOT** "tests pass" or "the binary compiles" — it is **"the end user of <flavor>herald can actually use the feature."**
2. Every PASS — unit test, integration test, gate, Challenge, smoke test, e2e — **MUST** carry positive runtime evidence that the user-visible behaviour works. Metadata-only PASS, configuration-only PASS, "absence-of-error" PASS, and grep-only PASS without runtime evidence are §11.4 PASS-bluffs and constitute critical defects regardless of how green the summary line looks.
3. Tests **AND** Challenges are bound **equally**. A Challenge that scores PASS on a non-functional feature is the same class of defect as a unit test that does.
4. The canonical Herald enforcement is `scripts/e2e_bluff_hunt.sh` — it builds pherald, runs the full test suite, starts a real Gin server, hits every `/v1/*` route, asserts response bodies, boots a real Postgres container via the `containers/` submodule, runs the M2 integration tests against the live DB, and SIGTERM-graceful-shutdowns. A single FAIL invariant means a real feature is broken for end users; no release tag, no risky commit, and no "implementation milestone landed" claim may be made while it FAILs.
5. New user-visible Herald features (V3 §§11, 33, 41, 42, 43 and beyond) **MUST** extend `e2e_bluff_hunt.sh` with a new `E_N` invariant in the same logical work effort — a feature that ships without its e2e invariant is shipping without anti-bluff evidence and violates §107.

Propagation. This §107 is restated verbatim (in summary form, citing this section as the canonical Herald source) in Herald's CLAUDE.md and AGENTS.md per §1.1 multi-file propagation discipline. The inheritance gate's invariant I8a-c asserts the anchor literal (End-user-usability covenant or the verbatim "all tests do execute with success" operator quote) is present in all three files; a missing copy is a propagation bluff and the gate FAILs.

Paired §1.1 mutation. A future generalised mutation-meta will assert that removing the §107 anchor from any of the three propagation files **MUST** cause I8a/b/c to FAIL — the §1.1 paired-mutation discipline is non-negotiable for every new gate.

Non-compliance is a release blocker. No flavor binary may be tagged, no submodule may be propagated, and no operator-handoff (docs/CONTINUATION.md) may be published while a §107 evidence-gap is open.

Overrides of Universal Constitution

(none — Herald has no exceptions to universal clauses at pre-implementation stage)

Owned-submodule set (per Universal §4)

submodules/auth	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/auth.git
submodules/background	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/BackgroundTasks.git
submodules/cache	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/cache.git
submodules/config	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/config.git
submodules/database	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/database.git
submodules/eventbus	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/EventBus.git
submodules/middleware	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/middleware.git
submodules/observability	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/observability.git
submodules/recovery	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/recovery.git
containers	→ git@github.com:vasic-digital/containers.git

Herald owns 10 vendored submodules — 9 Helix-stack capability modules under submodules/ (referenced via replace directives in consuming Herald modules' go.mod, NOT via go.work) plus containers/ (runtime auto-detection + on-demand container boot, consumed directly by Foundation tests + pherald doctor). Every one of them carries the §11.4 anti-bluff anchor; per Universal §11.4.74 they are catalogue-aware (extend|reuse|no-match discipline). The constitution itself is provided by the parent project, not vendored here — Herald never carries constitution/ (per §104).

Project-specific remotes

Repo	Remotes
Herald (this repo)	github, gitlab, gitflic, gitverse + origin (fan-out push to all four)

Notes

Herald's spec is now in V3 (docs/specs/mvp/specification.V3.md, ~3900 lines, active) — V1 and V2 are preserved under docs/specs/mvp/archive/ for historical reference. As project-specific articles mature toward universal status they may move into the Helix Constitution; promotion requires the §11.4 universal-vs-project audit. Default is to keep rules here until the audit clears.